GEO Playbook

Generative Engine Optimization — How to Win in the Age of AI-Powered Search

v. 2026-Jun-01

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Schneider Electric

Ask Your Questions on our Engage Community



[Engage – Global Search Optimization Group](#)

Revision Notes, Contributors & Reviewers

Generative Dynamics

The methodologies in this Playbook align with the latest observed trends in AI-driven discovery. Given the iterative nature of generative engines, these practices serve as a directional roadmap for optimization and will be updated as the AI landscape continues to mature.

Quarterly Refresh

This playbook is refreshed every quarter to incorporate platform changes, competitive data, and updated best practices.

Contributors	Role / Team
Umer Noor, Sanjay Mehta	eCommerce & Dist.
Matt Graves, Arun K. Ramaswamy	Global SEO
Ozgur Taskaya, Alina Tucan	E2E DCJ
Ramon Rubio	Offer Experience
Antoine Bisch, Giuseppe Forciniti	Tech. SEO / Web Perf. SE Digital

Reviewers	Role / Team
Anthony Locke	Dist. & eCom - Global CXCT
Eric Rehl	DCX – NAM Ops
Lauren Mahoney-Pick	Strategy Innovation Com.
Alain Fuss	Web Experience - SE Digital
Christophe Melle	Com & Marketing - EU Ops
Cedric Cabrol	DCX – EU Ops
Lena Henry	Global CXCT

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

What this playbook covers

1 **The AI Search Shift**
Why GEO matters now

2 **What Winning Looks Like**
The North Star & Opportunity

3 **The GEO Execution Loop**
Operating Loop & AI Mechanics

4 **Baseline setup -** (Phase 1)
Topics, prompts & measurement foundation

5 **Analyze -** (Phase 2)
Reading signals, diagnosing gaps & opportunities

6 **Optimize & generate -** (Phase 3)
Creating content that wins in AI search

7 **Bonus section: Sentiment analysis**
AI sentiment intelligence use-cases

8 **Appendix**
1 Pager GEO Operating Loop, Key terminologies

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

General

Part 1

The AI Search Shift — Why GEO Matters Now

Schneider Electric

What Is GEO? One Clear Definition.

Generative Engine Optimization (GEO) is the practice of making your content work for the AI reasoning layer that assembles answers - not just for human readers and not just for traditional search crawlers.

GEO is not a replacement for SEO. It is a parallel discipline that operates on a different logic: the AI does not rank pages. It synthesises answers from sources it trusts. A key goal is to become one of those trusted and citable sources.

THE SEO QUESTION:

"Can Google find and rank our page?"

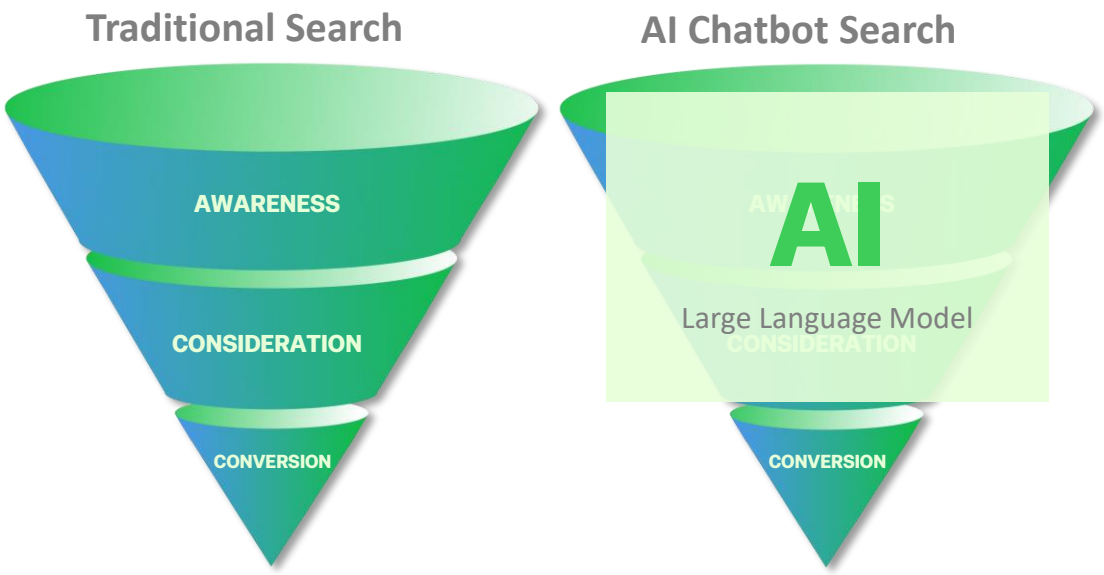
THE GEO QUESTION:

"When AI answers a customer's question, does it mention or recommend us?"

"GEO = making your information AI-ready: accessible, structured, and answer-shaped."

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

Impact on the Traditional Marketing Funnel



Impact of AI LLMs on the funnel

→ **Top:** *Awareness* is moving to AI chats: Brand visibility depends on being cited in LLM Engines.

→ **Middle:** *Consideration* is handled by LLMs: LLMs summarize reviews and specs quickly. If brand isn't recommended, the distribution network is weakened

→ **Bottom:** *Conversion* - Autonomous purchases are coming next: Unoptimized brands will get bypassed entirely

Key Takeaway: If we aren't mentioned on AI Chatbots, our downstream conversions weaken

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Understanding Zero Click Impact – The Invisible Churn

Before AI: The Blue Links Era

- → A buyer types a keyword-term
- → Gets 10 blue links
- → Clicks through multiple pages
- → Forms their own opinion

The brand that ranks high is positioned to win influence

Now: The AI Answer Era

- → A buyer asks a question
- → Receives one synthesized AI-generated answer
- → The AI cites multiple sources
- → The buyer acts on that answer by any of the following
  - ↳ They are satisfied on the first answer – Zero Click (no further click)
  - ↳ They run successive prompts generating multiple answers
  - ↳ They find their desired answer and **do no**t click further on any source
  - ↳ They find their desired answer and **do** click a source for Schneider

The brand that gets mentioned and/or cited wins influence

Key Takeaway: The channel has shifted from ranked links, to synthesized answers. GEO is how we compete in this new channel.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Part 2

What Winning Looks Like

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

NEW

The GEO Metric Ecosystem: Main KPIs

Visibility Score

FOUNDATION

"Are we in the room?"

A metric that tracks how often SE appears in AI answers

Share of Voice

PRIMARY KPI

"Are we winning the conversation?"

% of total brand mentions belonging to SE vs. all other brands.
This is effectively our market share of AI answers.

Citation Share

PRIMARY KPI

"Are we the trusted source?"

A metric that tracks how often SE specific citation is used across all citations, in AI answers.

Sentiment Score

SUPPORTING

"Is the AI narrative positive?"

% of AI-evaluated themes about SE that are positive vs. negative.

Key Takeaway: **Category Leadership on Share of Voice, and Citation Share vs top competitors, across key LLMs is the North Star KPI**

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

General

GEO Success – What Winning Means & Looks Like

AI is the new search layer. Winning here means becoming the brand AI trusts, favors & recommends in its answer to customer queries.

THE PRIZE

Be the **recommended brand** when AI answers buyer-questions on the prompts that drive revenue & brand equity

WON BY **OUTPERFORMING COMPETITORS** ON ▼

01 / LEVER

Share of Voice

Our share of mentions in AI answers. This is our relative visibility vs others.

02 / LEVER

Share of Citation

Our share of how often SE owned websites are cited. This is essentially our authority signal.

MEASURED ACROSS ▼

THE ARENA

- **ChatGPT**
- **Google Gemini**
- **Claude**
- **Perplexity**
- **Copilot**

For all **competitively contested topics & customer prompts**

Part 3

The GEO Execution Loop

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

GEO Execution Loop – 1 Pager

A structured, repeatable system for ensuring our brand is found, cited, and trusted by AI engines — across every stage of the buyer journey

BASELINE SETUP

Defines the competitive battlefield.

1. Select Topics

Apply Three-Filter Test

- Commercially Significant
- Queried
- Competitively Contested

→

2. Build Prompts

Map to Customer Funnel, Journey & Persona(s)

STAGE

- Awareness
- Consideration
- Decision

INTENT

- Informational
- Comparative
- Transactional
- Navigational

PERSONA

- [Custom Persona(s)]

→

3. Establish Baseline

Measure SoV & Citation Share

- Share of Voice
- Share of Citation
- Top 5 LLMs
- vs. Competitors

REVEALS THE COMPETITIVE GAPS

CLOSING THE GAP: THE THREE GATES

GATE 1: FETCHABLE

IS OUR CONTENT AI-ACCESSIBLE?

- ✓ Robots.txt allows AI crawlers (GPTBot, ClaudeBot)
- ✓ No login wall or gated form blocking content
- ✓ Page renders without heavy JS dependency
- ✓ Page speed < 3s TTFB; XML sitemap submitted

GATE 2: CHOSEN

DOES OUR CONTENT SIGNAL QUERY RELEVENCE

- ✓ URL is descriptive & keyword-rich
- ✓ Title tag matches query intent (not brand-first)
- ✓ Header tags align with target prompt
- ✓ Open Graph / structured data present (Schema)

GATE 3: EXTRACTABLE

CAN AI EXTRACT A PRECISE, CITABLE ANSWER?

- ✓ Key answer is in the first 100 words
- ✓ H2s/H3s map to fan-out sub-queries
- ✓ Factual density: stats & specs replace vague adjectives
- ✓ Tables & lists used for structured data

BEYOND THE GATES: CITATION AUTHORITY, EXTERNAL SIGNALS & INFLUENCE ORCHESTRATION

1. Map Citation Supply Chain

Identify who AI is currently citing (competitor vs. publisher vs. institution) and analyze winning formats.

2. Activate Partner Ecosystem

Equip channel and distributor partners with GEO Content Kits — ensuring partner pages rank for your products in AI-generated answers.

3. Earn Third-Party Coverage

Actively pursue reviews, analyst mentions, and industry publication features to build independent corroboration.

4. Strengthen Entity Signals

Optimize presence on LinkedIn, Wikipedia, and G2 to leverage the Consensus Principle across independent sources.

The GEO Operating Loop runs continuously. Measure/ Gaps Analysis → Internal Optimization → External Authority — compounds the gains.

BEFORE · No catalog access (nadigest not cited)

Prompt Execution

Which Protection Relay brands or models are best known for accurate fault detection and minimizing false trips?

Properties: ChatGPT · Dec 12, 2025 · United States

Visibility: Schneider Electric is mentioned 5th

Mentions: SEL · ABB · Siemens · GE · Schneider Electric · Eaton · Basler Electric · Mitsubishi Electric · Beckwith Electric · OMICRON

5. Schneider Electric

- Protection relays (e.g., SEPAM series) with **programmability and precision** suited for industrial and distribution systems

AFTER · Feb – Mar 2026 · nadigest cited

Prompt Execution

Which Protection Relay brands or models are best known for accurate fault detection and minimizing false trips?

Properties: ChatGPT · Mar 3, 2026 · United States

Visibility: Schneider Electric is mentioned 2nd

Mentions: Schweitzer Engineering Laboratories · Schneider Electric · Siemens · ABB · General Electric

**2. **

- Schneider's protection relays (e.g., **SEPAM Series**, PowerLogic P5/P7) are known for **sophisticated protection logic, customizable settings, and robust communication interfaces** (IEC 61850, Modbus, DNP3).
- These relays are widely used in **medium- and high-voltage distribution systems**, with strong performance on fault detection and minimized nuisance trips when properly configured.

Representative Models

- **SEPAM Series 80** – Digital protection with advanced fault discrimination and trip logic.
- **PowerLogic P5/P7** – Medium/high-voltage protection with integration into modern automation systems.

Named models now cited

SEPAM Series 80 and PowerLogic P5/P7 appear by name because nadigest contains their full range pages. Before, AI had no SE source to draw specific product names from.

Protocols directly attributed

IEC 61850, Modbus, DNP3 are now explicitly assigned to SE — drawn from verified spec tables in the catalog. Previously, IEC 61850 appeared only in a generic section, unattributed to any brand.

Performance claim grounded

The fault detection / nuisance trip claim is now specific and confident because AI read validated performance language from SE's own catalog — not inferred from third-party references.

The Anatomy of an Answer Engine

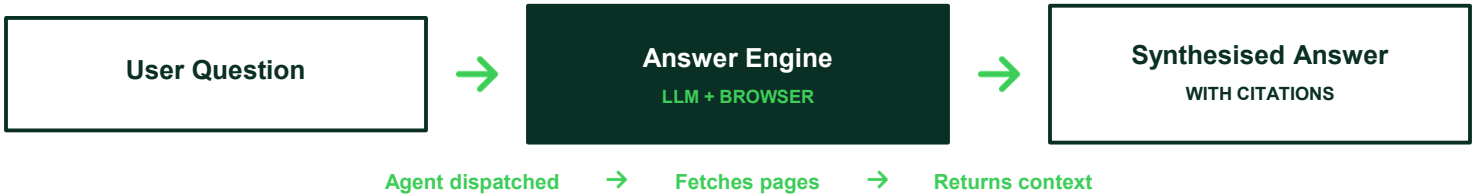
An answer engine is not simply a smarter search engine. It is a combination of two distinct components working together:

The LLM – Generative Layer

A large language model that can reason, write, and synthesize. On its own, it has no access to the live web - it can only work with what it already knows.

The Browser – Retrieval Layer

A browsing capability that dispatches agents to the open internet, fetches pages, and brings back content for the LLM to reason over.

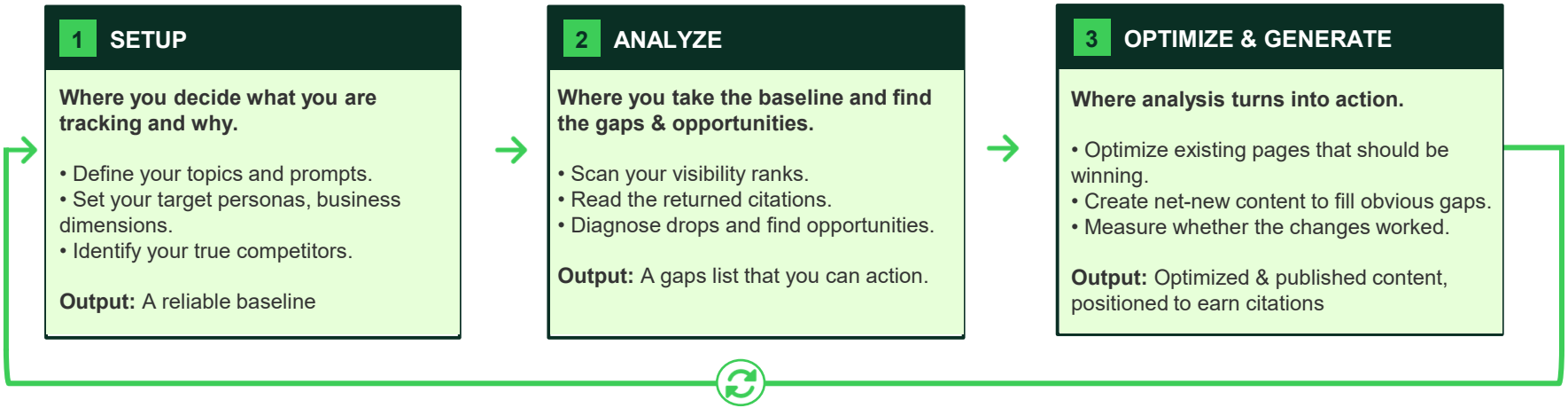


The AI does not only answer from memory - it also fetches real pages to ground its answer. Our pages must be fetchable, and content must be extractable to increase the likelihood of being cited for that answer.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Three Phases, One Continuous Loop

GEO is not a one-time project. AI answers drift as platforms update, competitors publish new content, and buyer questions evolve - the only way to sustain performance is a continuous operating loop.



Key Takeaway: **GEO is a loop, not a checklist — the three phases feed each other and compound over time.**

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

What Phase Are You In? The Decision Tool

Not sure where to start? Ask these four questions sequentially. The first time you answer 'No' is where your highest-priority GEO work begins.

1. Do we have a defined list of priority topics and a tracked baseline of our AI visibility?	NO → START AT PHASE 1: SETUP	YES ↓
2. Do we know exactly which AI engines we are losing on, and which of the Three Gates is blocking us?	NO → START AT PHASE 2: ANALYZE	YES ↓
3. Have we updated existing pages or published well-linked net-new content specifically designed to pass those failing gates?	NO → START AT PHASE 3: GENERATE	YES ↓
4. Are we measuring the impact of those changes and building a repeatable process for the next batch?	NO → START AT PHASE 2	YES ↓

Key Takeaway: Do not skip phases. You cannot generate effective content without analysis, and you cannot analyze without a baseline.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

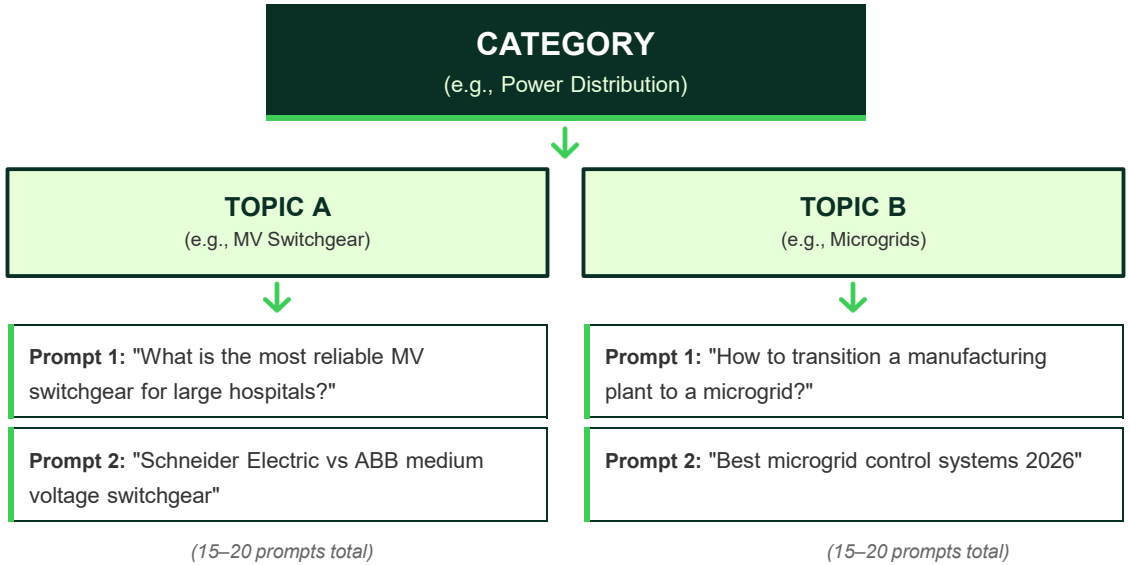
Part 4

Setup — Building Your GEO Measurement Foundation

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

Baseline Setup: Building Your GEO Measurement Foundation

GEO measurement is structured around a hierarchy each serving a distinct role in how you track, analyze and manage AI visibility.



Key Takeaway: The prompt is the unit of measurement. Topics are how you thematically group and manage them.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

How to Identify Strategic GEO Topics — The Three-Filter Test

Topic = A commercially significant, AI-queried, competitively contested battleground.

The prompt is the atomic unit: **Topic × Persona × Stage × Intent**

FILTER 1

Commercially Significant

Tied to a product line, solution, or market where SE has commercial priority and revenue goals.

FILTER 2

Queried

Real buyers are already asking this in AI engines or conventional Search Engines.

FILTER 3

Competitively Contested

SE faces known competition or needs to gain or defend market share

Topics That Pass All Three Filters

Topic	Product Line	Example Prompt	Competitors
Data Center UPS	Galaxy Series	*"Best UPS for edge data center?"*	Eaton, Vertiv
EV Charging Infrastructure	EVlink / Charge Pro	*"Best commercial EV charger for fleets?"*	ABB, Siemens
Variable Speed Drives	Altivar Series	*"Energy-saving drives for HVAC systems?"*	ABB, Siemens
Medium Voltage Switchgear	SM6 / PIX Series	*"MV switchgear for industrial plant upgrade?"*	Siemens, ABB

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

How to Source Customer Centric Prompt Themes

Unlike keywords, Prompts require a different research approach - and a structured process to build a list that is both trackable and commercially meaningful.

WHY THIS IS DIFFERENT FROM KEYWORD RESEARCH

	Keywords	Prompts
Volume data	Publicly available	Zero
Query length	Short and structured	No limit — long-form, conversational
Example	*"best MV switchgear"*	*"What is the most reliable MV switchgear for a hospital with strict uptime requirements?"*

Three Practical Sources

01

Mine Google Search Console

Filter for "what," "why," "how," "where" phrases to uncover the actual questions users are asking before they arrive at your site.

02

Use Predictive Text

Type core topics into Google or an AI engine and capture the auto-suggested questions. These reflect real-time user intent.

03

Query AI Engines Directly

Type your seed topic into Perplexity and watch the sub-queries it fires. These are live fan-out signals — the exact questions the AI decomposes your topic into, and the content gaps you need to fill to earn a citation.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

How to Build Prompts Across Topics

PROMPT = Topic × Persona × Stage × Intent

Anchor Topic: Data Center UPS

Dimensions Reference

PERSONA

Full list: SE Customer Personas (Spice Portal)

STAGE

Awareness — Learning about the problem; no vendor in mind yet

Consideration — Evaluating options and comparing vendors

Decision — Ready to act; seeking final justification or ROI proof

INTENT

Informational — Seeking to understand a concept or technology

Comparative — Evaluating two or more vendors side by side

Transactional — Seeking pricing, specs, or procurement guidance

Navigational — Looking for a specific brand, product, and place directly

DIMENSION 1: **PERSONA**

Who is asking?

SAMUEL - The IT Solution Provider

"What is the most reliable 3-phase UPS for a mid-size data center?"

DAVID - The Data Center C-Level

How to future-proof data center power infrastructure for high-density AI workloads?"

DIMENSION 2: **STAGE**

Where are they in the journey?

AWARENESS

"How does a UPS protect a data center from power outages and AI workload spikes?"

CONSIDERATION

"Schneider Galaxy VX vs Eaton 9395P — which is better for a 500kW data center?"

DIMENSION 3: **INTENT**

What are they trying to do?

INFORMATIONAL

"What is double-conversion UPS technology and why does it matter for AI data centers?"

COMPARATIVE

"Schneider Electric Galaxy vs Vertiv Liebert - pros and cons for enterprise data centers"

How Different Tag Combinations Identify Competitive Gaps

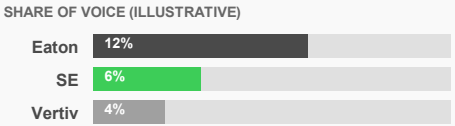
The same Topic reveals different insights when viewed through different tag combinations (lenses).

Anchor Topic: Data Center UPS

LENS 1: **Persona: SAMUEL** × **Intent: Comparative**

"Schneider Galaxy VX vs Eaton 9395P for mid-size data center"

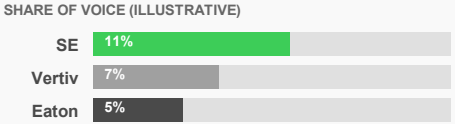
COMMERCIAL STAKES: Buyers are actively comparing brands. If Eaton dominates the recommendations, SE falls off the final RFP.



LENS 2: **Persona: DAVID** × **Stage: Decision**

"What is the ROI of upgrading to high-efficiency modular UPS for AI data centers?"

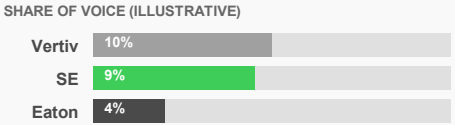
COMMERCIAL STAKES: Final vendor selection based on cost and ROI. Winning here drives direct, closed-won revenue.



LENS 3: **Persona: SOFIA** × **Stage: Awareness** × **Intent: Informational**

"Best power redundancy architecture for Tier III data centers"

COMMERCIAL STAKES: Whoever effectively educates the engineer early is strongly positioned to influence the answer.



©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Part 5

Analyze — Reading Answer Signals to Uncover Gaps & Opportunities

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

The Visibility Drop Diagnostic: A Step-By-Step Overview

When Brand Visibility or Citation Share suddenly drops, do not immediately rewrite content. Follow this protocol to isolate the variable and deploy the right fix.

1 VERIFY THE DROP

Is the drop isolated or broad?

Drop on one LLM only:
May indicate a LLM-level change or a competitor gaining ground on that engine — not necessarily a content problem.

Drop across all LLMs:
More likely a content quality, structural, or technical issue affecting all AI retrieval pipelines.

2 CHECK THE GATES

Did we break something?

Gate 1 — Crawl access:
Did a recent site update block AI crawlers via robots.txt or JavaScript rendering changes?

Gate 2 — Page identity:
Did a URL change or page title edit disrupt the AI's semantic match to our content?

3 ANALYZE REPLACEMENT

Who took our spot?

Examine the new citation winner for:

→ More recent data or updated statistics?

→ Better structured lists or direct-answer format?

→ A more specific, query-matched page?

→ Stronger third-party authority signals?

4 FORMULATE THE FIX

Deploy the right solution.

Technical issue:
Restore crawl access or fix the broken page identity signal.

Content gap:
Restructure for extractability, refresh stale data, or build a net-new asset in the winning format.

Authority gap:
Build third-party citation presence — earned media, reviews, industry publications.

Bottom Line Takeaway: Diagnose before you prescribe. A drop in visibility may be technical, algorithmic, a content gap, or an authority gap — each requires a different response.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Citations Share Analysis Basics: Reading the Returned Citations

Every AI answer has returned citations. Understanding the winners before acting is the strategic starting point.

LENS 1

Domain Mix

"Who is the AI trusting for this topic?"

If competitor pages dominate
→ owned content can win here

If Institutions dominate (Wikipedia, govt.)
→ earned media and institutional coverage become the primary citation pathway

If Publishers dominate
→ your route is through those outlets

LENS 2

Page Type & Format

"What format is winning?"

If list-format content dominates but SE has only narrative guides
→ restructure for extractability and structured content hierarchy

If no page answers your exact prompt
→ an unaddressed content gap and a citation opportunity

If the topic appears only as a subsection in broad pieces
→ dedicate a standalone page strengthens citation eligibility for that topic

LENS 3

Competitive Citation Rank

"Where do we stand in the lineup?"

If competitor at #1, you at #8
→ study their page structure and citation-earning signal

If SE has no current citation presence for this topic
→ creation gap (NEW CONTENT), not a quality gap

If SE is cited but not prioritized in the citation hierarchy
→ likely a structure, freshness, or authority signal issue

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Brand Visibility vs Citation Share: Reading the Gap

Being mentioned by AI ≠ being cited by AI. Each gap signals a different strategic problem — and a different fix.

SCENARIO 1 — AUTHORITY GAP

High Mentions, Low Citations

We are known to AI — but not trusted as a source.

SE appears in AI-generated answers, but our owned pages are rarely cited as a source. AI has trained on our name, yet does not treat our content as authoritative enough to reference directly.

→ Build third-party citation authority: earned media, industry publications, structured data, partner coverage

SCENARIO 2 — AWARENESS GAP

Low Mentions, Low Citations

We have no presence on AI's training surface for this topic.

SE is absent from AI-generated answers entirely. This is a content creation and distribution gap - not a quality issue. There is insufficient owned or third-party content for AI to surface.

→ Create foundational owned content and distribute it across channels AI indexes and trusts

SCENARIO 3 — POSITIONING GAP

High Citations, Weak Positioning

We are cited, but framed as a secondary or niche option.

SE appears in AI answers, but as a comparison point or alternative - not the primary recommendation. AI has not associated our brand with category leadership signals for this query.

→ Strengthen entity associations: earn "best of" citations, increase co-mentions with category leaders, own the primary purchase-intent query

Key Takeaway: Mentions = presence. Citations = authority. Positioning = how AI frames us in the answer. Each gap requires a nuanced response.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Brand Sentiment: Reading the Signal, Finding the Source

AI sentiment captures how — not just whether — we are mentioned. Platforms like Profound and Semrush run thousands of prompts, classify each response, and bucket mentions by topic to surface where sentiment is positive, cautious, or negative.

SENTIMENT EXAMPLE · ILLUSTRATIVE



A 25% negative share is a signal that requires immediate tracing — even a small negative fraction can erode buyer confidence when neutral sentiment is high.

HOW PLATFORMS MEASURE IT

- Structured prompts are executed across LLMs; every response is thematically buckets and scored in terms of positive, negative or neutral sentiment.
- Sentiment is calculated as a percentage — positive vs. negative — and tracked daily for trend shifts.
- Recurring themes reveal which topics AI associates with the brand.

SIGNAL INTERPRETATION

GREEN FLAGS

- Consistent brand messaging across sources
- High citation from trusted third-party partners
- Endorsement language in category-level prompts

RED FLAGS

- Recurring specific complaints across multiple prompts
- Competitor comparisons that favour rivals
- Factual inaccuracies or hallucinated product claims

Root Cause Diagnostic Protocol

1 Isolate the Signal

Identify the specific topic, product line, or prompt category driving the negative mention. Read the actual AI response — what language is being used and what claim is being made?

Illustrative example:
AI response flags 'pricing transparency on specialty configurations' as unclear. Topic: Circuit Breakers - Specialty Pricing.

2 Trace to Source

Identify which websites, forums, or articles the AI is referencing for the negative claim. The number of sources signals whether this is isolated or systemic.

1–2 Sources	Many Sources
Perception issue — isolated or outdated feedback	Reality issue — systemic or broad consensus

3 Classify & Act

Perception Problem	Isolated source or outdated content	→ Publish counter-content; update source material
Messaging Gap	AI cannot find our differentiating claims	→ Create extractable, differentiated content
Reality Gap	Broad consensus across many sources	→ Escalate to product or support teams
Hallucination	Factually incorrect AI claim	→ Correct source content; strengthen entity data

Key Takeaway: AI sentiment is a symptom. The citation supply chain holds the diagnosis — isolate the topic, trace the source, classify the problem, and act accordingly.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Part 6

Optimize & Generate — Creating Content That Wins in AI Search

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

The Three Gates: How Content Gets Cited

All content essentially passes through three gates for retrieval for an AI-generated answer.

Failing any one gate significantly reduces - and in the case of Gate 1, eliminates your chances of appearing in an AI-generated answer, regardless of content quality

GATE 1 — FETCHABLE

"Can the AI agent reach and read our page?"

- Is the page publicly accessible (no paywall, no login wall)?
- Do robots.txt rules allow AI crawlers?
- Does the page load cleanly without heavy JavaScript blocking?

GATE 2 — CHOSEN

"Does our page look like the answer before the AI opens it?"

- URL clarity: does the URL signal what the page is about?
- Title precision: does the title match the prompt intent?
- Meta description: does it signal utility and coverage?

GATE 3 — EXTRACTABLE

"When the AI opens your page, can it lift a clean answer chunk?"

- Is the key information near the top (not buried deep)?
- Is the content structured with clear headings?
- Are answers written in self-contained, dense paragraphs?



Key takeaway: When SE is not appearing in AI answers, the diagnosis starts here: which gate are we failing?

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

General

Understanding How AI Expands Our Prompts Before We Write

AI engines expand a single prompt into related sub-queries to provide a comprehensive answer.

The Query Fan-Out Effect

Seed: "What is the best SF6-free switchgear?"

↓ AI Expands To ↓

1. How does pure air technology work?
2. What is the cost comparison vs traditional?
3. Are there maintenance differences?
4. What are the regulatory compliance benefits?

3 Considerations Before Writing or Optimizing

1. **Does the content answer the seed prompt directly?**
   Start with a clear, concise definition or direct answer in the first paragraph.
2. **Does it address the implied sub-questions?**
   Use H2s and H3s to structure the page around the expanded fan-out queries.
3. **Does it contain specific citable facts?**
   Include numbers, percentages, and verifiable data points that AI engines prefer to cite.

Guideline: Content that addresses only the seed prompt is positioned for a single citation opportunity. Content that covers the full fan-out cluster is strategically positioned to earn citations across multiple sub-query responses

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

The Generate Mindset: Write for the AI Retrieval Layer

The core mindset shift is this: in GEO you are no longer writing just for human readers or traditional search crawlers. You are writing to be extracted by an AI agent.

TRADITIONAL MINDSET

- ✕ **Narrative Flow:** Building up to the main point to keep the reader engaged on the page longer.
- ✕ **Marketing Fluff:** Using too many adjectives like "industry-leading," "innovative," and "revolutionary."
- ✕ **Visual Reliance:** Putting the most important data inside charts, infographics, or videos.
- ✕ **Broad Coverage:** Trying to rank for high-volume keywords by covering everything vaguely.

THE GEO MINDSET

- ✓ **Inverted Pyramid:** Answering the specific question right at the top of the page.
- ✓ **Factual Density:** Using concrete statistics, specifications, and verifiable claims.
- ✓ **Text-First Structure:** Ensuring all key information is available in clean, readable HTML text.
- ✓ **Prompt Alignment:** Structuring header-tags to align with the fan-out queries.

Key Takeaway: Make your content "agent-ready." If an AI cannot extract a clean, factual answer in milliseconds, it will move to a competitor's page.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

The Five-Dimension Content Audit

Before you rewrite a page or create a new one, evaluate your existing content against these five dimensions. This framework identifies exactly why an AI engine is choosing a competitor's page over yours.

1. Relevance

"Does it directly answer the prompt?"

AI engines penalize "fluff." If the user asks about maintenance, the page should ideally lead with maintenance.

2. Factual Density

"Are there concrete stats and specs?"

AI prefers hard data over adjectives. Replace "highly efficient" with "reduces energy consumption by 15%."

3. Semantic Structure

"Are headers aligned with the query?"

Headings should ideally match the fan-out queries. If the prompt asks "How to install," there should be an H2 to reflect that.

4. Recency

"Is the information up to date?"

Engines like Perplexity (and most others) prioritize recent information. Outdated specs or old publication dates will cause you to lose citations.

5. Authority

"Are there credible citations?"

Does the page link to internal whitepapers, cite industry standards (e.g., IEEE), or include quotes from verified experts?

Key Takeaway: A page that scores high on all five dimensions is "agent-ready" and highly likely to win the citation.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

UPDATED

How to Optimize an Existing Page for GEO

You do not always need to write net-new content. Often, a page already has the right information but is structured poorly for AI extraction. Execute these five moves to make an existing page "agent-ready."

1	**Match the PrompT/kw**	Rewrite your header tags to reflect answerability to the questions users are asking the AI (e.g., change "Our Solutions" to "What is the best MV switchgear for hospitals?").
2	**The Answer Paragraph**	Immediately following the heading, provide a concise, 40-60 word paragraph that ideally answers the question without any introductory build-up.
3	**Inject Factual Density**	Replace vague claims with hard data. Swap "highly efficient" for "reduces energy loss by 15%." AI models prioritize verifiable statistics and specifications.
4	**Structural Clarity**	Break up long blocks of text. Use bulleted lists, numbered steps, and HTML tables. AI engines can extract structured data much faster than narrative paragraphs.
5	**Remove the Fluff**	Thin out the excessive marketing adjectives, "sales speak," and long narrative introductions. If a sentence does not contain a fact, a stat, or a direct answer, consider removing.

Key Takeaway: Optimisation is often an exercise in subtraction and restructuring, not just adding more words.

The Answer-Shaped Paragraph: How to Write for AI Citation

The 3-Part Answer Structure

1. Lead with Subject & Primary Function

Start the paragraph by explicitly naming the product/topic and stating exactly what it does in plain language.

2. Add Specific Citable Differentiator

Include a verifiable fact, number, or unique technology that sets it apart (e.g., "uses pure air technology").

3. Name Target Application or Audience

Specify who it is for or where it is used to help the AI match the product to user intent.

The Transformation

BEFORE (BRAND-FORWARD)

"Experience the future of sustainability with our innovative MV solutions designed to empower your business."

AFTER (ANSWER-SHAPED)

"The RM AirSeT is an SF6-free medium voltage switchgear that uses pure air technology, designed for commercial buildings and utilities."

Why This Structure Works

AI models are trained to extract factual answers to specific questions. By pre-formatting your content as a direct, factual answer, you reduce the model's need for inference and paraphrase, meaningfully increasing the probability that your content is cited directly

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

The Citation Economy: Why Channel Is Our Superpower

Approximately over 80% of AI citations come from 3rd Party sources.

Where 3rd Party Citations Come From (further breakdown of 80%)

More than half ~50% - Channel Ecosystem (Distributors, Partners, Retailer, Integrators etc)

~30% - Earned, Social & Industry Media

~ 20% - Owned, Competition, Other

The Compounding Loop

1. **Owned Content Builds Foundation**
   You establish the primary facts, specs, and definitions on se.com.
2. **Partner & Earned Coverage Confirms Signal**
   Distributors and media echo those qualifiers, creating a web of corroboration.
3. **Brand Recognition Compounds**
   The AI engine sees the consensus and elevates Schneider Electric as the definitive answer.

The Consensus Principle

- AI engines look for consensus across multiple independent domains. If your site says you are the best, it's just marketing.

- When multiple independent, authoritative sources corroborate the same claim, AI engines are strongly inclined to treat it as a consensus signal and cite it as such.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

The Channel Orchestration Strategy

3 Core Best Practices

1. Encourage Semantic Consistency – Entity mapping

Ensure partners use the same product names, specs, and definitions as se.com.

2. Enable Partners to Enhance Thin Pages

Provide partners with rich, factual content to replace thin, auto-generated product descriptions.

3. Encourage Corroboration Loop

Ask partners to include descriptive back-links to your canonical technical documents.

How to Activate

1. **Audit Partner Pages**
   Identify top distributors ranking for your target queries.
2. **Build GEO Content Kits**
   Create a standardized kit of answer-shaped paragraphs and spec tables.
3. **Monitor as Citation Nodes**
   Track if AI engines begin citing these partner pages for your products.
4. **Authority content templates**
   Frameworks for partners to publish their own application guides and technical commentary.

The GEO Content Kit for partners should be **citation infrastructure**, not marketing material.
We should support them with structured, factual content that AI engines are optimized to extract and cite.

1. Answer-Shaped Description

A 50-70 word factual paragraph that directly answers what the product is and what it does.

2. HTML Spec Table

The top 8-10 specifications formatted as a clean HTML table (not an image or PDF).

3. FAQ Pack

3-5 Question & Answer pairs addressing the most common buyer sub-queries.

4. Context & Canonical Link

Application context and a descriptive back-link to the canonical source on se.com.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

GEO Content Kit Summary

BU Centric Actions

Quick Wins – Existing Content Adaptation

- ❑ Add direct-answer summary blocks to existing how-to guides
- ❑ Enrich existing case studies with outcome statistics
- ❑ Product page FAQ sections [under review]

Medium Effort – Content Creation

- ❑ “How to select” decision guides by product category
- ❑ Expert Q&A / technical commentary articles
- ❑ Comparison articles – SE Products vs application alternatives

Deep Dive – Content Creation

- ❑ Structured product semantic attribute
- ❑ Glossary/terminology pages
- ❑ "Frequently compared" product landing pages
- ❑ Segment-specific product selection guides

Authority content framework for third-party citations

- ❑ Templates and guidelines for partners to write their own expert articles - application guides, use cases, technical commentary. The type of content AI engines trust and cite most often.

NOTE:
Stay tuned in Engage for the upcoming GEO Playbook + Toolkit updates.

Benefits to Key Stakeholders

Partners receive a complete, ready-to-deploy content Kit
SE controls how its products are described by AI engines across the network.

- Quick Win content enhancement kit, tailored basis partner strategy & focus
- Ongoing incremental development of other mid term deliverables
- Partner empowerment to develop own authoritative content

SE’s existing advantage

SE already produces ecommerce ready content. AI-ready content is a structured extension of assets that already exist.

- SE's existing product data for e-commerce is the foundation. AI-ready formatting is an extension, not a new content creation exercise from scratch
- SE's product marketing and BU teams carry the category expertise that authority content requires - the knowledge already exists internally
- Best Online Partner Program already certifies and distributes digital content standards - AI-ready content is an additional layer on an existing delivery mechanism

BUs role - participation

Business units must be fully onboarded and actively engaged before AI-ready content can be produced at scale. Without their investment and creation of GEO-ready content, we risk not being able to scale.

Recommended training for BU leaders and Product Managers involved with GEO content strategy and creation

Coursera - AI SEO: Mastering generative engine optimization (GEO)

Part 7

Bonus Section —Sentiment Analysis Use-cases

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Schneider Electric

BONUS SECTION

AI Sentiment Intelligence

Proactive brand narrative intelligence - measure how AI is framing Schneider Electric in front of key customer personas.

BEFORE — Passive & Lagging

Brand perception via surveys & NPS reports
Analyst briefings - results arrive weeks later
You find out at last what customers think

NOW — Proactive & Real-Time

AI is having real-time conversations about our brand with millions of customers.
We can now track, analyze, and act first.

HOW THE INTELLIGENCE SYSTEM WORKS (Persona use-case)

01

Map Persona Question Sets

Work with persona owners to define the list of prompts reflecting the persona's key considerations. Each persona becomes a *tracked topic*.

02

Track LLM Sentiment Across Platforms

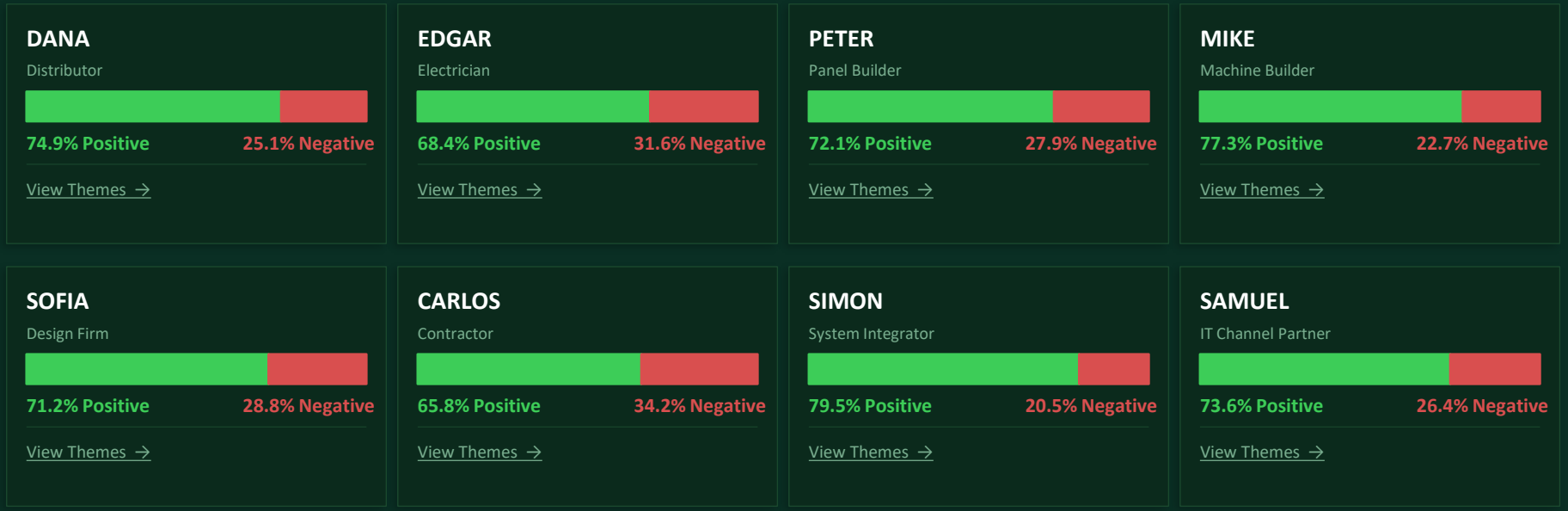
Run prompt sets across key LLMs via tracking platform at a topic level. It will give you the negative and the positive themes per LLM Model.

03

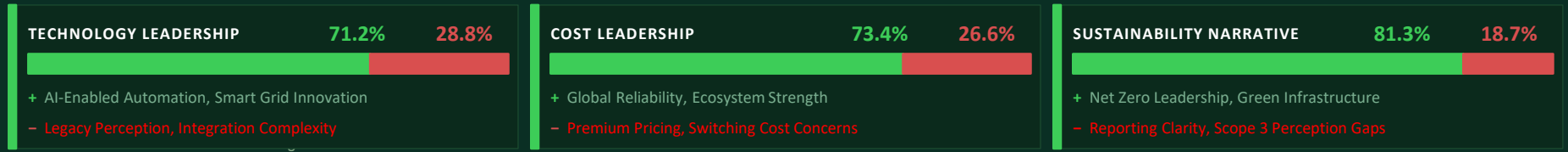
Identify Gaps, Model Bias & Trigger Fixes

Uncover the citation sources behind negative themes. Each gap maps to a content intervention — addressed in the GEO content chain strategy.

AI Sentiment Tracking - Persona · (Illustrative-Example)



AI Sentiment Tracking - Leadership Topic · (Illustrative-Example)



Thank You

This Playbook was made possible by the early GEO support and advocacy of Steven Javor, Eric Rehl, and the SE Electrifier community.

Recognizing also the early conviction & efforts of;

- *Anthony Locke*
- *Arun Kumar Ramaswamy*
- *Lauren Mahoney-Pick*
- *Lena Henry*
- *Matt Graves*
- *Meric Karacaev*
- *Salman Kureishi*
- *Sanjay Mehta*
- *Shonodeep Modak*
- *Yusuf Hakimuddin*

APPENDIX

Glossary of GEO Terms

GEO (Generative Engine Optimization)
Making content work for the AI reasoning layer that assembles answers — parallel to SEO, not a replacement.

Three Gates
The sequential filters content essentially passes through to appear in AI answers: Fetchable (can AI reach it?), Chosen (does it look like the answer?), Extractable (can AI lift a clean answer chunk?).

Query Fan-out
How AI engines expand one user question into multiple shorter, search-shaped sub-queries — each returning candidate pages for the synthesised answer.

Citation Share
The percentage of all AI citations that reference our specific domains or pages.

Share of Voice (SoV)
The percentage of total brand mentions belonging to SE brand vs. all other brands across AI answers.

Visibility Score
A metric tracking how often a brand appears in AI-generated answers. Binary per response: present or not. Can be aggregated across multiple Prompt executions & topics.

Sentiment Score
% of positive vs. negative AI-evaluated sentiment themes across prompts about SE.

Answer-Shaped Content
Factual, structured, direct content formatted for AI extraction - leads with the answer, not long marketing narratives.

Citations Returned
The sources AI trusts for a given prompt or topic, domain mix, page type, and competitive citation rank.

The GEO Execution Loop
Setup → Analyze → Optimize & Generate. A continuous three-phase cycle, not a one-time project.

Consensus Principle
Prior to recommending/ answering, AI engines look for corroboration across multiple independent sources before treating a claim as citable fact.

Answer Engine
An LLM + Browser combination that synthesizes answers from fetched web pages, not just ranks links.

Five-Dimension Content Audit
Relevance, Factual Density, Semantic Structure, Recency, Authority - the framework for evaluating page quality.

The Inverted Pyramid
Writing structure that leads with the direct answer, then supporting facts - opposite of narrative build-up.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Internal — Confidential

General

How do AI Bots get their data?

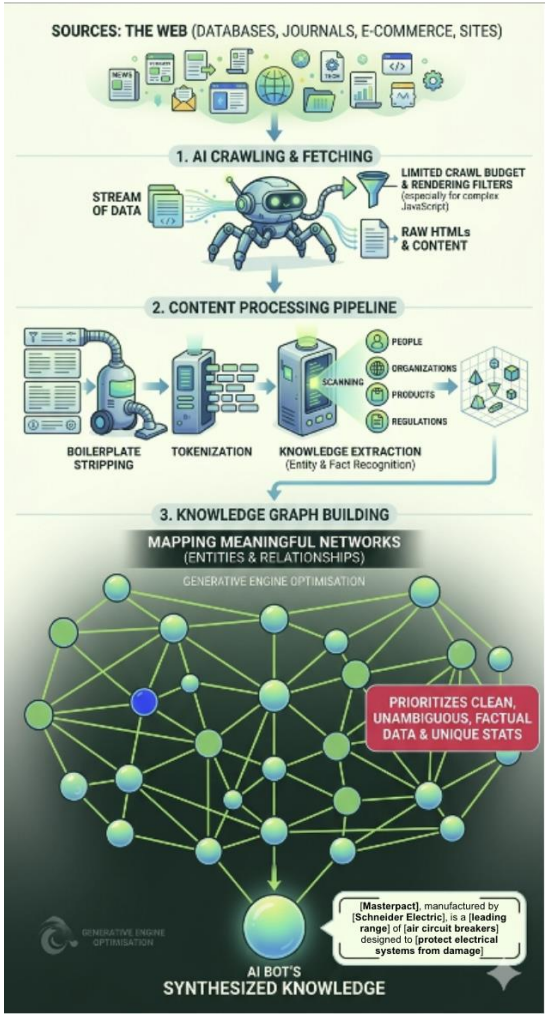
Retrieval from the Web

- **AI crawlers** fetch data from **web** pages, read their **raw information** and **break down** their contents to **enrich their models**
- They have **limited crawling budget** and **rendering capabilities** (particularly non-Google products)

What do they value?

- **Clear entities**: Distinct concepts such as people, organizations, products, dates, etc.
- **Clean / unambiguous / factual data**, **unique statistics** and **fresh insights**

AI engines cite sources that provide clean, structured, reliable data that is easy to crawl



©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Creating Net-New Content

Optimize Existing or Build Net-New?

Ask these 3 questions before creating a new page:

1. Format Match?

Is the current page the right format for the winning query? (e.g., AI prefers a listicle, but you have a product page).

2. Density Sufficient?

Can we add enough factual density to the existing page without ruining the user experience?

3. Gap Unanswered Anywhere?

Is there a specific, high-value sub-query that is completely unaddressed on your domain?

If the answer points to a gap, build or optimize for a highly targeted "Scalpel Page."

The GEO "New Content Brief Template"

Target Query:	The exact prompt we want to win.
Fan-Out Cluster:	The 3-5 sub-queries to address as H2s.
Target Audience:	Who the AI should recommend this to.
Content Format:	Listicle, comparison, guide, or FAQ.
Content Guideline:	Respect the E-E-A-T guidelines 🔗
Required Facts:	Specific numbers, specs, and data points.
Prohibited Language:	Marketing fluff or ambiguous terms.
Success Criterion:	The exact AI output we expect to see.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved

Technical Docs & Data Sheets: Unlocking our Richest Content Asset

Why Technical Docs Are High-Value

Data sheets, spec sheets, and manuals contain the factual density and specificity that AI engines are optimized to extract and cite

- High factual density (numbers, specs)
- Objective, non-marketing tone
- High trust and authority signals

Why PDFs Alone Are Not Enough

PDFs are often "black boxes" to AI crawlers.

- **No JSON-LD Schema:** Cannot provide structured data to bots.
- **Multi-Column Parsing:** AI often misreads tables and columns in PDFs.
- **Gated URLs:** If a PDF requires a form fill, the AI cannot read it.

The Solution: HTML-First, PDF-Also

Avoid publishing standalone PDFs without an accompanying HTML gateway page. The HTML-first approach is strongly recommended to maximize AI crawlability and citation potential

1. **Create an HTML Gateway Page**
   A dedicated, indexable URL for the document.
2. **Embed the PDF**
   Provide the downloadable asset for human users.
3. **Add Schema Markup**
   Inject JSON-LD to tell the AI exactly what the document is.
4. **Extract Specs as HTML**
   Pull the top 5-10 specifications out of the PDF and put them directly on the HTML page as a table or FAQ.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.

Technical Docs Infrastructure: Best Practices for Hosting & File Quality

3 Infrastructure Guidelines

1. Permanent Stable URLs

Avoid dynamic links or temporary hosting. AI engines need stable URLs to build citation confidence over time.

2. Open to Crawlers

Ensure document repositories are not blocked by robots.txt. For retrieval-augmented AI engines, content that cannot be crawled in real time is effectively invisible — regardless of its quality.

3. Descriptive Filenames

Use keyword-rich names (e.g., rm-airset-mv-switchgear-spec.pdf) instead of generic strings (doc12345.pdf).

Internal PDF Metadata Optimization

Title: Exact product name and document type.
Subject: Brief, answer-shaped description.
Author: Schneider Electric.
Keywords: Primary and secondary target queries.

PDF File Quality Checklist

- ✓ Text-searchable (not just scanned images).
- ✓ Proper heading tags (H1, H2) used within the PDF authoring tool.
- ✓ Clean, single-column layout where possible for easier AI parsing.
- ✓ Optimized file size for fast loading.
- ✓ Embedded links back to related Schneider Electric HTML pages.

©2026 Schneider Electric. All Rights Reserved.